39. Interview with Dinesh Sharma, deputy chief minister, UP, 8 June 2020, Lucknow.
40. Full text of Narendra Modi's speech in Alwar on 25 November 2018, available in Hindi at: https://www.narendramodi.in/text-of-pm-s-address-at-public-meeting-at-alwar-rajasthan-542495.
41. Sunetra Choudhury, 'Panel may recommend splitting 27% OBC quota into three bands', *Hindustan Times*, 31 December 2019, https://www.hindustantimes.com/india-news/panel-may-recommend-splitting-27-obc-quota-into-three-bands/story-9XUA9UWxL9qE6vVABUeINN.html. For a critical analysis, see Yogendra Yadav, 'From Mandal to Modi, OBC categorisation caught up in bad politics', 15 July 2020, https://theprint.in/opinion/mandal-modi-obc-sub-categorisation-caught-up-in-bad-politics/461498/.
42. PIB Delhi, 'Cabinet approves extension of term of the Commission constituted under Article 340 of the Constitution to examine the issue of sub-categorization within Other Backward Classes in the Central list', 14 July 2021, https://pib.gov.in/PressReleaseIframePage.aspx?PRID=1735389; Damini Nath, 'OBC Commission's tenure extended by 6 months', *The Hindu*, 24 June 2020, https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/obc-commissions-tenure-extended-by-6-months/article31904996.ece.
43. The National Commission for Backward Classes was reconstituted as a constitutional body w.e.f. 15.08.2018 by insertion of a new Article 338B in the Constitution through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018. This made the powers available to the NCBC as per Article 338B the same as those available to the National Commission for Scheduled Castes as per Article 338. Krishan Pal Gurjar, Minister of State for Social Justice and Empowerment, Lok Sabha Unstarred Question No. 1761, 2 July 2019, http://loksabhaph.nic.in/Questions/QResult15.aspx?qref=1957&lsno=17. Further, the Constitution (One Hundred and Twenty Seventh Amendment) Act, 2021, was passed by Parliament on 11 August 2021. It amended the 2018 legislation to allow states and union territories to make their own lists of socially